



Deam Software Solutions

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

CRICAUTION — CRICKET AUCTION & LIVE SCORING

Administrator Guide

Run the season: approvals, tournaments, teams, and the hammer.

Who this is for. The tournament director. Everything in the application that requires a decision is yours.

What is in this guide

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1 What you are responsible for

Five things, in the order they happen:

- 1 **Create the tournament** — its four dates, and the secret code players join with.
- 2 **Approve registrations** — confirm each person is real.
- 3 **Approve applications** — decide who is in this tournament. This is what fills the auction list.
- 4 **Create the teams** and name one owner for each.
- 5 **Run the auction**, then set up matches for the scorers.

YOU

Create the tournament

four dates + a secret code

Approve the registration

"this is a real person"

Approve the application

creates the player and the auction lot

Create teams, name owners

Run the auction

THEM

Player registers

name, address, mobile, photo, email

Player applies with the code

Owner names the team

renameable until the deadline

Owners bid

Scorer records every ball

The two approvals are different, and the second is the important one

Approving an *account* says the person is real. Approving an *application* puts them in the auction — it creates their player record and their auction lot in the same instant. There is no third step, and nothing to forget on the morning of the auction.

2 Your hub

Signing in lands you on the administration hub. The two panels at the top are the queues that hold everything else up.

The screenshot shows the CricAuction Administration hub. At the top is a navigation bar with the CricAuction logo, an 'Overview' tab, and links for People, Tournaments, Applications, and Teams. On the right of the navigation bar are links for 'Tournament Director', 'ADMIN', and 'Sign out'. The main content area is titled 'Administration' with the subtitle 'Everything that needs a decision, in one place.' Below this are two large panels: 'REGISTRATIONS TO APPROVE' showing a count of 1 and 'TOURNAMENT APPLICATIONS' showing a count of 2. Under these are four smaller panels: 'TOURNAMENTS' (1), 'TEAMS' (6), 'PLAYERS' (60), and 'SCORERS' (1). A section titled 'WHAT YOU CAN DO HERE' contains six cards: 'People' (approve registrations, correct details, create scorer accounts), 'Tournaments' (create tournament, read secret code, open/close entries), 'Applications' (decide who gets into each tournament), 'Teams' (create each team, name owner, set team name), 'Run the auction' (start next lot, take bids), and 'Score a match' (scorer's pad, ball by ball, with an undo). At the bottom of the interface is the text 'CricAuction — auction and live scoring'.

CricAuction Overview People Tournaments Applications Teams Tournament Director ADMIN Sign out

Administration

Everything that needs a decision, in one place.

REGISTRATIONS TO APPROVE
1
Players waiting to be let into the application stage.

TOURNAMENT APPLICATIONS
2
Approving one puts that player into the auction list.

TOURNAMENTS
1

TEAMS
6

PLAYERS
60

SCORERS
1

WHAT YOU CAN DO HERE

People
Approve registrations, correct anybody's details — including the name and email a player cannot change — create scorer accounts, and reset passwords.

Tournaments
Create a tournament with its four dates, read off its secret code, and open or close entries.

Applications
Decide who gets into each tournament. Approving is what puts a player into the auction list.

Teams
Create each team and name its one owner. The owner sets the team name and can change it until the deadline.

Run the auction
The live board: start the next lot, take bids, and bring the hammer down.

Score a match
The scorer's pad. Ball by ball, with an undo.

CricAuction — auction and live scoring

The hub. Both queues link straight to the screen that clears them.

3 Creating a tournament

Administration → Tournaments → Create a tournament.

FIELD	WHAT IT MEANS
Tournament name	Unique within a season
Season	The year
Auction date	When the hammer falls. Entries close at the end of this day
Start date	First ball of the season. Must be on or after the auction
End date	Last day of the season
Team name change deadline	The last day an owner may rename their own team
Purse per team	In rupees. 5000000 = ₹50 L
Bid increment	The step between bids. 50000 = ₹50,000
Minimum squad	Smallest legal squad. Drives the reserve rule owners run into
Maximum squad	A team at this number cannot bid again
Overseas limit	Overseas players one squad may hold
Overs per innings	20 for T20

The dates are checked against each other: the end cannot precede the start, the auction cannot fall after the first ball, and the name deadline cannot outlast the season. Any of them can be left blank while the calendar is unsettled and filled in later.

The screenshot shows the CricAuction interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links: CricAuction, Overview, People, Tournaments (active), Applications, Teams, Tournament Director, ADMIN, and Sign out. Below this is the 'Tournaments' section. It features a card for 'APL 2026' with details: 6 teams, 60 players, and 2 waiting. A 'SECRET CODE' 'BATSMAN7' is displayed. Below the card are buttons: AUCTION, ENTRIES OPEN (highlighted), Edit, Close entries, and Issue a new code. Below the tournament card is the 'CREATE A TOURNAMENT' section. It includes a note: 'A secret code is generated for you. Players apply with it, and appear in the auction list only once you approve them.' The form has two columns of input fields: TOURNAMENT NAME, SEASON (2026), AUCTION DATE (optional, mm/dd/yyyy), START DATE (optional, mm/dd/yyyy), END DATE (optional, mm/dd/yyyy), TEAM NAME CHANGE DEADLINE (optional, mm/dd/yyyy), PURSE PER TEAM (₹) (optional, 10000000), BID INCREMENT (₹) (optional, 500000), MINIMUM SQUAD (optional, 11), MAXIMUM SQUAD (optional, 15), OVERSEAS LIMIT (optional, 4), and OVERS PER INNINGS (optional, 20). A 'CREATE TOURNAMENT' button is at the bottom. The footer says 'CricAuction — auction and live scoring'.

The tournament list. The secret code is shown in full — this screen is behind your sign-in, which is what makes the code worth anything.

The secret code

Generated for you, eight characters, shown on the tournament card. It is the only way a player joins. Hand it out however suits you — a WhatsApp group, a poster, read out at a meeting.

Why codes look the way they do

They never contain 0, O, o, 1, I, l or i — the characters people mistake for one another when a code is read aloud or written on a whiteboard. It costs nothing and removes an entire category of support call.

Issue a new code replaces it — for when the old one has gone further than you intended. Applications already filed are unaffected; only new ones need the new code.

Close entries stops new applications without touching anything else. Entries also close automatically at the end of auction day.

Upgrading an existing tournament

A tournament created before this version has no code and no dates. Press **Issue a new code**, then **Edit** to set the four dates. Two minutes.

4 Approving registrations

Administration → **People**. The **Waiting** tab is everyone who has registered and not yet been decided on, with everything they submitted — name, email, mobile, address, kind of player and photo.

The screenshot shows the CricAuction web application interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'CricAuction' logo and links for Overview, People (active), Tournaments, Applications, and Teams. On the right, it says 'Tournament Director ADMIN Sign out'. Below the navigation bar, the 'People' section is active, showing tabs for 'Waiting', 'Approved', 'Rejected', 'Suspended', and 'Everyone'. The 'Waiting' tab is selected, displaying a user card for 'Arun Prasad'. The card shows a profile picture with the letter 'A', the name 'Arun Prasad', email 'arun.prasad@club.test', and phone number '9847012345'. The address is '18 Beach Road, Alappuzha'. To the right of the card, there are labels 'PLAYER' and 'PENDING'. Below the card, there are buttons for 'Approve', 'Reject', 'Edit details', and 'Reset password'. Below the user card, there's a section titled 'CREATE A SCORER OR ADMINISTRATOR' with instructions: 'Scorers do not register themselves — you create the account and hand over the credentials. Leave the password blank and one is generated for you; either way the account has to change it at first sign-in.' This section contains a form with fields for 'FULL NAME', 'EMAIL ADDRESS', 'PASSWORD' (with a note 'optional' and 'Leave blank to generate one.'), 'USERNAME' (with a note 'What they sign in with.'), and a 'ROLE' dropdown menu currently set to 'Scorer'. A 'CREATE ACCOUNT' button is at the bottom right of the form. At the very bottom of the page, it says 'CricAuction — auction and live scoring'.

The registration queue.

ACTION	WHAT IT DOES
Approve	They can sign in and apply to a tournament
Reject	They cannot sign in. The sign-in screen tells them plainly
Edit details	Correct anything, including the name and email a player cannot change
Reset password	Issues a new password, shown once

You are the only one who can fix a name or an email

A player cannot change either — that is the rule they agreed to when registering, and it is what keeps an approved identity stable. But people do mistype their own email address, so somebody has to be able to fix it. That somebody is you.

Account status on the edit form can be set to *Suspended* at any time. A suspended account is turned away on its very next click, not whenever its session happens to expire.

5 Letting players into a tournament

Administration → **Applications**. Pick the tournament along the top; the badge is how many are waiting.

The screenshot shows the 'Applications' page for the 'APL 2026' tournament. The page has a dark blue header with navigation links: CricAuction, Overview, People, Tournaments, Applications (active), and Teams. On the right, there are links for Tournament Director, ADMIN, and Sign out. Below the header, the 'Applications' section title is followed by a subtitle: 'Approving somebody puts their name straight into the auction list for APL.' A badge indicates 'APL 2026' with '2' pending applications. Below this, there are tabs for 'Waiting' (selected), 'Approved', 'Rejected', and 'All'. Two application cards are visible. Each card shows a player's profile picture (initials), name, email, phone number, address, and role. The first player is Nikhil Rao, an ALL ROUNDER, with a 'PENDING' status. The second player is Sarita Balan, a WICKET KEEPER, also with a 'PENDING' status. Both applications were applied for on 11 Aug 2026. Each card has a form with three input fields: 'BASE PRICE (₹) optional' (with a value of 200000), 'AUCTION SET optional' (with a placeholder 'Marquee, Set A...'), and 'NOTE optional' (with a placeholder 'Kept on the record.'). There is also a checkbox for 'Overseas'. At the bottom of each card are two buttons: 'APPROVE — ADD TO THE AUCTION' (green) and 'REJECT' (red).

The approval queue. What you set here is what the auction uses.

Three things are set at the moment of approval, because this is the only point at which somebody is actually looking at the player:

Base price	The lowest anyone may bid. Defaults to ₹2,00,000
Auction set	A free label used to group the pool — Marquee, Set A ...
Overseas	Counts against the tournament's overseas limit
Note	Kept on the record with your name and the date

Approve creates the player record and their auction lot at the back of the queue, in one step. **Reject** creates nothing, and the player may apply again.

A team owner can be a player too

If an owner applies, approve them like anyone else. They will appear in the auction and can be bought by another team. Being an owner neither adds them to the auction nor keeps them out.

6 Teams and their owners

Administration → Teams. Choose who will own the team, give it a working name and a 2–6 character short name, and create it. The purse comes from the tournament.

The screenshot shows the 'Teams' page in the CricAuction application. The page has a dark blue header with the CricAuction logo and navigation links: Overview, People, Tournaments, Applications, and Teams (highlighted). On the right of the header are links for Tournament Director, ADMIN, and Sign out.

The main content area is titled 'Teams' and includes a sub-header: 'Each team has exactly one owner. The owner sets the team name and can change it until **18 Aug 2026**.' Below this is a green button labeled 'APL 2026'.

There are four team entries, each in a light blue box:

- Coastal Titans** (CT): Owner: Coastal Titans Owner (ct@apl.local). Purse Left: ₹170.00 L (11 bought). Fields: RENAME (Coastal Titans), SHORT (CT), HAND TO (Choose a person...). Buttons: Save, Assign.
- Desert Falcons** (DF): Owner: Desert Falcons Owner (df@apl.local). Purse Left: ₹440.00 L (4 bought). Fields: RENAME (Desert Falcons), SHORT (DF), HAND TO (Choose a person...). Buttons: Save, Assign.
- Harbour Warriors** (HW): Owner: Harbour Warriors Owner (hw@apl.local). Purse Left: ₹456.00 L (3 bought). Fields: RENAME (Harbour Warriors), SHORT (HW), HAND TO (Choose a person...). Buttons: Save, Assign.
- Highland Chargers** (HC): Owner: Highland Chargers Owner (hc@apl.local). Purse Left: ₹420.00 L (4 bought). Fields: RENAME (Highland Chargers), SHORT (HC), HAND TO (Choose a person...). Buttons: Save, Assign.

Teams and owners. The name here can be a placeholder.

The name really can be a placeholder

The owner sets the real name themselves and can change it right up to the team name change deadline. That is what the deadline is for — it lets a name be settled with the squad after the auction, then freezes it before fixtures are printed.

Assign hands a team to a different owner. The outgoing owner is released in the same step, because a team may only ever have one owner — the database enforces it, not just the screen.

After the deadline an owner can no longer rename their team, but you still can, from this screen.

7 Creating scorer accounts

Administration → People → Create a scorer or administrator.

Fill in a name, a username, an email and the role. Leave the password blank and one is generated — two four-character groups, drawn from the same unmistakable alphabet as the tournament codes, so it can be read down a phone line.

The credentials are shown once

They are not stored anywhere you can read them back. Write them down or send them before you leave the screen. If you lose them, use **Reset password** and issue new ones — no harm done.

The account must change the password at first sign-in, so what you hand over never stays in use.

8 Running the auction

Starting it

Nothing is under the hammer until you put it there. Open the auction board — **Run the auction** from the hub, or the **Auction** tab.

Before the first lot the board reads **No auction is running**, with a single button: **Open the first player**. It tells you how many are queued. Press it, and the first player is live with the countdown running.

If the button is not there

It appears only when players are actually queued. If instead you are told nobody is queued, no application has been approved yet — and approving an application is what creates a player's auction lot. Go to **Administration** → **Applications** first.

The controls

Once a lot is live, your controls sit under the player card.

BUTTON	DOES	WHEN
Next player	Puts the next queued player under the hammer	The previous lot has been closed
Sold	Awards the player to the leading team and debits the purse	Bidding has stopped and someone leads
Unsold	Closes the lot with no winner; the player returns to the pool	The countdown expired with no bid
Pause	Freezes the countdown	A dispute, or a break
Reset timer	Puts the countdown back to full	You gave the room more time

The rhythm of a lot:

- 1 The next player appears with base price, role and career record.
- 2 Owners bid. Each bid restarts the countdown, so the room decides when bidding is over — not the clock.
- 3 The countdown reaches zero, or the room goes quiet.
- 4 Press **Sold** — or **Unsold** if nobody bid. Every screen updates immediately.
- 5 Press **Next player** to open the following lot, and go round again.

One press per lot, deliberately

The next player does not come up by itself. An auction has a rhythm the room sets — a sale gets a reaction, somebody asks a question, an owner wants a moment to count. You decide when the next name goes up.

Pressing **Next player** while a lot is still open is refused, with “Close the current lot before starting the next one.” Nothing is skipped by a double-press.

Sold is final

There is no undo on a sale. The lot closes, the player joins the squad and the money moves in one transaction — all of it or none of it, so a player can never be sold without the purse being debited. But it cannot be reversed from the application. When you are unsure, **Pause** instead.

Re-listing unsold players

Unsold players stay in the pool. To bring them back for a second round, an existing lot is re-opened rather than a new one created — a player has exactly one lot for the season. This is still done in the database:

```
UPDATE auction_lots
  SET status = 'queued', current_bid = NULL, current_bidder_team_id = NULL,
      bid_count = 0, started_at = NULL, ends_at = NULL, closed_at = NULL,
      lot_order = lot_order + 1000
  WHERE tournament_id = 1 AND status = 'unsold';

UPDATE players
  SET status = 'available'
  WHERE tournament_id = 1 AND status = 'unsold';
```

Bids from the first round stay in the log as history; the new round starts from the base price again.

9 Setting up a match

This part is not on a screen yet

Creating a fixture, the playing elevens and the first innings is done in the database. Everything from the first ball onward is driven from the application.

```
-- 1. The fixture. toss_decision is 'bat' or 'bowl'.
INSERT INTO matches
(tournament_id, match_number, stage, team_a_id, team_b_id, venue,
 scheduled_at, overs_per_innings, toss_winner_team_id, toss_decision,
 status, scorer_user_id)
VALUES
(1, 1, 'league', 1, 2, 'Marine Drive Ground', NOW(), 20, 1, 'bat', 'live',
 (SELECT id FROM users WHERE username = 'your.scorer'));

-- 2. The playing eleven per side. batting_order drives "next batter in".
INSERT INTO match_squads
(match_id, team_id, player_id, batting_order, is_playing_xi, is_captain, is_wicket_keeper)
VALUES (1, 1, 4, 1, 1, 1, 0),
       (1, 1, 8, 2, 1, 0, 0);
-- ... eleven rows per team

-- 3. The first innings.
INSERT INTO innings (match_id, innings_number, batting_team_id, bowling_team_id, started_at)
VALUES (1, 1, 1, 2, NOW());
```

The match must be `status = 'live'` and the innings must exist, or the scorer sees a practice scorecard instead of yours — their badge will read **Demo** rather than **Saving**.

10 Passwords and lockouts

Your own: Password in the top bar, on any screen.

Somebody else's: People → **Reset password** on their row. A new one is generated and shown once. Read it to them; they must change it immediately.

The very first administrator is created by `database/reset.sql` :

Username	<code>admin</code>
Email	<code>admin@example.com</code>
Password	<code>ChangeMe@2026</code>

Change it, then change the email

That password is published in the project source, so the account is created already marked as needing a new one — the first sign-in cannot get past the change-password screen. Do that, then correct the name and email under **People**.

11 Starting clean, and demonstrating

Two files, both run from **phpMyAdmin** → **your database** → **SQL**. Export a backup first; neither can be undone.

A genuinely empty application

`database/reset.sql` deletes every player, team, user, bid, match and ball, and leaves one administrator so you can still sign in. Afterwards every screen says so plainly — that is correct for an empty application, not a fault.

Data for a demonstration

`database/demo_apl.sql` loads a complete tournament: six franchises, a 60-player pool, an auction part way through with a player under the hammer, two completed squads, and a match ready to score.

Run `reset.sql` first, then `demo_apl.sql`. Every demonstration account uses the password `ChangeMe@2026` :

ROLE	USERNAME
Administrator	<code>apl.admin</code>
Scorer	<code>apl.scorer</code>
Viewer	<code>apl.viewer</code>
Team owners	<code>apl.ct</code> , <code>apl.mr</code> , <code>apl.hc</code> , <code>apl.df</code> , <code>apl.hw</code> , <code>apl.sl</code>

The demonstration tournament's secret code is `BATSMAN7`, and its four dates are written relative to the day you import it — so a demonstration never opens on a season that finished last year.

Demonstration data is not for real use

Those passwords are published in the project source. Run `reset.sql` again before the tournament goes live.

12 What the application does not do yet

Stated plainly, so nothing is a surprise mid-tournament.

- 1 **No bulk player import.** Registrations, approvals, tournaments, teams and owners all have screens. A CSV import does not exist yet, so a club moving an existing pool across has each player register.
- 2 **Fixtures are set up in the database.** See *Setting up a match*.
- 3 **Only the first innings.** The innings break, the second-innings target, the chase and the result are not implemented.
- 4 **No sale undo.** Correcting a mistaken **Sold** means a database edit.
- 5 **No email.** Approvals, rejections and issued passwords are not emailed. Somebody has to tell the person; every state is visible on their own screen.
- 6 **No password reset by email.** You reset it and read out the new one.
- 7 **Screens refresh every three seconds** rather than being pushed instantly. Fine for a club tournament.
- 8 **No fixtures, points table or statistics screens.** The data is recorded; the pages that display it are not built.

13 If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
A player applied but is not in the auction	The application has not been approved. Applications → Approve — that is the step that creates the lot
“That code does not match any tournament”	Wrong code, or it was re-issued. The current one is on the tournament card
“Entries are closed”	The auction date has passed, or entries were closed by hand
An owner cannot rename their team	The deadline has passed. You still can, from Teams
Somebody cannot sign in	Check their status under People — pending, rejected and suspended all refuse
A scorer’s badge says Demo	They are not signed in as the scorer, or no match is live
Landing page shows an old tournament	Previous data still loaded. Run <code>reset.sql</code>
<code>#1701 Cannot truncate a table...</code>	An old copy of <code>reset.sql</code> . The current one uses DELETE and works with foreign key checks on
503 Service temporarily unavailable	The database is unreachable. Check the connection settings and the error log

14 Words you will see

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Secret code	The eight characters a player types to join a tournament
Application	A player asking to join a tournament. Approving one creates their auction lot
Approved	Two meanings, kept separate: an approved <i>account</i> is a real person; an approved <i>application</i> is in the auction
Name change deadline	The last day an owner may rename their own team
Lot	One player being auctioned
Base price	The lowest a player can be bought for
Purse	Money a team has to spend
Increment	The fixed step between bids
Reserve	Purse held back so a team can still complete a legal squad
Unsold	A lot that closed with no bid; the player can be re-listed

15 Getting help

Two different kinds of problem, and they go to different people.

KIND OF PROBLEM	WHO TO ASK
Your account, your details, approvals, tournament codes, deadlines	Your tournament administrator — they can change all of it
The application itself: a page that will not load, a wrong number, something broken	Deam Software Solutios, through your administrator

When reporting a fault, say what you were doing, what you expected, and what happened instead. A photograph of the screen is worth a paragraph.